

CASE TITLE: The Gilded Fountain Poisoning DATE: August 22, 2026 OFFICER IN CHARGE: Detective Elena Rossi

SUMMARY: During a high-profile charity gala, billionaire philanthropist Winston Gable collapsed after drinking from a communal punch bowl. Toxicology reports confirm the presence of a fast-acting neurotoxin.

SUSPECTS:

1. Victor Gable: Winston's estranged son and sole heir to the family fortune.
2. Dr. Aris Thorne: A research scientist whose funding was recently cut by Gable's foundation.
3. Sophia Vane: Gable's personal secretary who was recently caught selling confidential documents to the press.

WITNESS STATEMENTS:

1. Victor Gable: "I didn't even touch the punch. I spent the whole night at the blackjack table in the west wing."
2. Sophia Vane: "I prepared the punch myself under strict supervision. Nobody had access to the bowl once it was placed on the pedestal."

PHYSICAL CLUES:

- A small, empty glass vial found tucked behind a decorative curtain near the beverage station.
- A purple-stained linen handkerchief found in Victor Gable's tuxedo pocket.
- A residue of fine white powder on the rim of a single crystal glass found under the head table.

SUSPICIOUS DETAILS: Sophia Vane claimed she was under "strict supervision," yet security footage shows a four-minute gap where she left the beverage station to attend a phone call in the hallway. Additionally, Victor Gable stated he never touched the punch, yet the purple stain on his handkerchief matches the specific chemical dye used in the 'Gala Grape' punch served that evening, suggesting he handled a saturated object or the liquid itself.